

TOPIC 3: DUTIES OF A RECEPTIONIST

1. Main Duties

- Receive and welcome visitors politely
- Answer telephone calls and take messages
- Direct visitors to the appropriate person or office
- Keep a visitors' book or register
- Manage appointments and waiting area
- Handle simple enquiries and provide basic information
- Maintain a tidy and professional reception area

2. Qualities of a Good Receptionist

- Politeness, patience and a friendly manner
- Good communication skills (spoken and written)
- Neat appearance and professional dress
- Ability to remain calm under pressure
- Honesty, reliability and discretion
- Basic knowledge of the organisation's structure

3. How to Receive and Treat Visitors

Greet with a smile; ask how you can help; listen carefully; offer a seat if they must wait; inform the right person; do not leave visitors unattended for long; thank them when they leave.

4. Summary

A receptionist's duties centre on welcoming people and managing first contact. Good qualities and correct procedures create a positive image for the organisation.

End of Topic 3